

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 12, 2026 (Part 2)

Compiled summary for Wednesday, August 12, 2026 - Part 2 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy section after the August 12 Part 1 During Shopping pass, adding Step 6b and Step 6c right-column shopping overlay variants, isolating visible overlay/button layers through transparent PNG assets, keeping the overlay bottom orange banner visible after user review, cropping transparent top and bottom regions out of the derivative assets, rebuilding Step 6 with the screenshot under the device frame and the device frame on top, matching Step 6 corner rounding to the existing Step 1 and Step 2 framed screenshots, adding the Viewing Area brace treatment to Step 6, introducing a new Tutorial subsection above Pre-Scrolling with a single blank large device frame on the left and an empty right column, renaming Visual Hierarchy headers into Primary/Secondary/Tertiary/Quaternary Focus labels, clearing stale local dev caches, validating TypeScript, static export, browser-rendered layout, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generating the August 12 Part 2 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf` and after the August 12 Part 1 documentation state. The source commit reviewed for this record is 529c8b2 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. That commit contains the Visual Hierarchy Tutorial row, Step 6b/6c shopping overlay variants, Step 6 frame/corner correction, focus-label rename, and asset work described here. No separate Hostinger production deployment command was run during this worklog-generation pass; the user specifically requested local preview at `http://127.0.0.1:3000` during the visual pass. The new local artifacts produced for this record are the refreshed project snapshot and this August 12 Part 2 PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including project notes, source tree, public image and font inventories, PDF worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, git context, recent commits, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: `portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf`.
- Extracted text from all twenty-six existing Portfolio PDFs with `pdftotext` and checked recent metadata with `pdfinfo` to preserve title cadence, Part 2 naming, opening-summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and Helvetica-style base-font convention.

- Used portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf as the closest same-day structural baseline because it documented the immediately preceding Alla Vostra Visual Hierarchy row expansion, Step 4/5 transparent asset handling, Step 6 During Shopping screenshot wiring, local cache-clearing pattern, browser-measurement workflow, and documentation language.
- Reviewed git history and state through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git branch -vv, git status, git diff --stat, git diff --name-status, git diff --check, source-specific diff checks, file inventory commands, sharp metadata checks, npm validation commands, and local route checks. HEAD and origin/main resolved to 529c8b2 before this PDF was generated.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/globals.css, portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, public/images/alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png, public/images/products_overlay_piccola_framed_no_island.png, public/images/products_overlay_piccola_isolated_large.png, public/images/products_overlay_piccola_overlay_only_large.png, package scripts, and the local /projects/alla-vostra route.

Baseline Status Before August 12 Part 2 Work

- August 12 Part 1 had already built the Visual Hierarchy section into three conceptual rows: PRE-SCROLLING, ON-SCROLLING, and DURING SHOPPING. Step 1 and Step 3 were large left-column framed examples; Step 4 and Step 5 were smaller right-column no-frame/mosaic examples; Step 6 used the Piccola products overlay screenshot as the first During Shopping example.
- Step 6 initially used the raw Piccola overlay screenshot directly, so it did not yet share the exact device-frame depth order, rounded-corner aperture, external Viewing Area brace system, or left-column large-stack framing language used by Step 1 and Step 3.
- The user wanted Step 6b on the right side of the Step 6 stack: smaller, without a device frame, and with all grayed-out, dimmed, dark, or inactive screenshot regions made fully transparent while keeping the top-right SHOP button, shopping cart, large overlay, arrow buttons, center button, and close button visible.
- The user then wanted Step 6c to look like Step 6b but with the X button, arrow buttons, center button, cart button, and shop button fully transparent. Later correction clarified that the bottom orange banner inside the overlay should stay visible in both 6b and 6c.
- The derived Step 6b and Step 6c files needed their fully transparent top and bottom zones physically cropped out so invisible rows would not reserve space in the right-column screenshot stack.
- The conceptual row spacing still needed one more pass: the in-between vertical space between Visual Hierarchy subsections had to be twice the spacing between a subsection label and its first image, preserving the accepted 24px label-to-image gap and roughly 48px gap between rows.
- The section did not yet have a Tutorial subsection above Pre-Scrolling. The user wanted that row to contain one large empty device frame on the left, with the right side left blank until future tutorial imagery exists.
- The visible stack headers still used Step labels. The user wanted the primary left-column screenshots labeled PRIMARY FOCUS and the smaller right-column stacks labeled SECONDARY FOCUS, TERTIARY FOCUS, and QUATERNARY FOCUS from top to bottom within each subsection.

Goals for August 12 Part 2

- Add Step 6b and Step 6c as right-column During Shopping variants without disturbing the accepted Step 6 left-column placement or the earlier Pre-Scrolling and On-Scrolling rows.
- Generate transparent shopping-overlay PNG assets that preserve only the intended visual hierarchy layers, then crop transparent zones out of their actual file bounds and wire the resulting aspect ratios into the React layout.
- Rebuild Step 6 so the screenshot is the underlay and the device frame is the overlay, then match the same rounded-corner device aperture used by Step 1 and Step 2.
- Apply the Viewing Area brace, text, and section-line treatment to Step 6 so the During Shopping primary image communicates the same hierarchy taxonomy as the earlier large stacks.

- Double the spacing between Visual Hierarchy subsections relative to the label-to-image gap, while keeping the layout readable in the local UI Foundations view.
- Add the Tutorial subsection above Pre-Scrolling with one large empty framed device on the left and an intentionally empty right column.
- Rename Visual Hierarchy stack headers into focus labels while preserving the underlying step ids and CSS class hooks used for deterministic grid placement.
- Keep the work local to <http://127.0.0.1:3000>, clear stale development caches when source and browser output disagree, run TypeScript/static-export validation, refresh the snapshot, and produce the August 12 Part 2 PDF worklog in the established Portfolio format.

Work Completed - Context, Local Server, and Cache Handling

- Continued from the committed August 12 Part 1 documentation state after da37f3c and then documented the later source commit 529c8b2, Added Alla Vostra visual hierarchy tutorial and focus variants.
- Kept the local Next.js development server available at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> for user inspection and confirmed /projects/alla-vostra returned HTTP 200 during the Part 2 verification pass.
- Cleared the development cache when requested by the user and again when Turbopack served stale CSS or optimized image output after rapid JSX, CSS, and PNG asset changes.
- Restarted the dev server on 127.0.0.1:3000 after cache removal so visual checks ran against the current source and generated images rather than stale .next artifacts.
- Used Playwright repeatedly to switch to UI Foundations, scroll to the Visual Hierarchy group, read image sources and natural dimensions, measure label-to-stack gaps, capture Step 6 and full-section screenshots, and verify that the rendered page matched the intended source state.

Work Completed - Step 6b and Step 6c Shopping Overlay Variants

- Added Step 6b and Step 6c to the Visual Hierarchy sequence after Step 6, increasing the Visual Hierarchy visible step limit from nine to eleven and later to twelve once the Tutorial row was added.
- Generated public/images/products_overlay_piccola_isolated_large.png as the Step 6b no-frame shopping-overlay asset at 1440 x 2862. The file keeps the overlay, top-right SHOP button, shopping cart, close button, arrow buttons, center Products button, and overlay-internal bottom orange banner visible while alpha-clearing the surrounding dimmed/dark regions.
- Generated public/images/products_overlay_piccola_overlay_only_large.png as the Step 6c no-frame overlay-only asset at 1440 x 2241. The file preserves the product overlay and its internal orange footer but alpha-clears the surrounding SHOP button, cart button, close button, arrow buttons, and center Products control.
- Cropped away transparent-only top and bottom zones from Step 6b and Step 6c so the right-column stacks reflect the visible asset bounds instead of reserving the original full-screen transparent height.
- Matched the Step 6b and Step 6c display width to the other small-column screenshot stacks by centering their no-frame images at a 318px frame width inside the same 432px stack width family.
- Marked the transparent shopping-overlay variants unoptimized so Next image handling would not flatten alpha channels or continue showing older optimized derivatives during local review.

Work Completed - Step 6 Device Frame, Rounding, and Viewing Area

- Replaced the raw Step 6 Piccola overlay source with public/images/products_overlay_piccola_framed_no_island.png, a 1290 x 2661 framed composition built from the Piccola overlay screenshot and the accepted Alla Vostra no-island device frame.

- Corrected the compositing order so the Piccola screenshot sits underneath and the device frame sits on top, fixing the requested df-over-ss layering rather than allowing the screenshot to obscure edge chrome.
- Matched Step 6 corner rounding to the Step 1 and Step 2 framed screenshots by using the same full-phone canvas size and a larger rounded screen aperture, then explicitly punched the reference screenshot out of the frame overlay so only the device chrome remained above the new underlay.
- Changed Step 6 to direct-load the framed PNG rather than using the Next optimized /_next/image path, making repeated image-generation corrections visible immediately after local refreshes.
- Added Step 6 to the Viewing Area treatment by grouping it with Step 1 and Step 3 for the external brace, brace text, section-line widths, callout label sizing, large-stack zoom, and section-frame pair spacing.
- Verified Step 6 in browser context with a targeted Playwright screenshot and confirmed the live image source was /images/products_overlay_piccola_framed_no_island.png with natural dimensions 1290 x 2661 and rendered dimensions matching the accepted large-stack footprint.

Work Completed - Visual Hierarchy Spacing, Tutorial Row, and Focus Labels

- Added Visual-Hierarchy-specific section-break variables so the distance between subsection groups is twice the label-to-image gap, preserving about 24px between a row label and first image and about 48px between one subsection stack and the next subsection label.
- Inserted Step 0 at the top of the Visual Hierarchy sequence as the Tutorial primary-focus placeholder and added TUTORIAL as the first row label above PRE-SCROLLING, ON-SCROLLING, and DURING SHOPPING.
- Generated public/images/alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png at 1290 x 2661 as a blank black screen inside the same no-island device shell, giving the Tutorial row a real empty phone frame instead of the generic Screenshot pending placeholder.
- Placed the Tutorial stack in the left column at full large-stack scale and intentionally left the right side blank, matching the user instruction that no Tutorial right-column image exists yet.
- Reworked the Visual Hierarchy grid rows after inserting Tutorial so Step 1/1b/1c/1d, Step 2, Step 3/4/5, and Step 6/6b/6c kept deterministic two-column placement beneath the new first subsection.
- Replaced visible Step headers with semantic focus labels through a visualHierarchyStepTitles map: Step 0, Step 1, Step 3, and Step 6 now render PRIMARY FOCUS; right-column stacks render SECONDARY FOCUS, TERTIARY FOCUS, and QUATERNARY FOCUS as appropriate.
- Preserved the underlying Step ids and CSS classes, including flow-screen-stack-step-0 through flow-screen-stack-step-6c, so the visual labels can change without destabilizing placement selectors or source-step logic.

Work Completed - Commit and Documentation Context

- Recommended the user-requested commit message in one-header plus hyphen-line format, covering the Tutorial subsection, focus-label rename, Step 6b/6c transparent shopping variants, Step 6 frame rounding, Viewing Area brace treatment, and spacing adjustments.
- The source work was committed as 529c8b2, Added Alla Vostra visual hierarchy tutorial and focus variants, with app/globals.css, app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, the refreshed snapshot, and the four generated PNG assets included.
- Confirmed after that commit that main and origin/main matched at 529c8b2 before beginning the August 12 Part 2 worklog-generation task.
- Regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt during this worklog pass, then used the refreshed snapshot, all extracted prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and current git state as source material for this August 12 Part 2 record.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed with tsc --noEmit during the August 12 Part 2 source pass and again during this worklog-generation pass.
- npm run build:static passed during this worklog-generation pass, with Next.js 16.2.10 compiling successfully and prerendering /, /articles, /projects/alla-vostra, and /projects/cinerific as static routes.
- curl -I http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra returned HTTP 200 OK while the local dev server was running on 127.0.0.1:3000.
- Playwright confirmed the Visual Hierarchy section could be inspected after switching to UI Foundations and measured TUTORIAL, PRE-SCROLLING, ON-SCROLLING, and DURING SHOPPING row labels in the expected vertical order.
- Browser measurements confirmed the Tutorial row contains only the left-column blank framed device at 432px stack width and approximately 720.8px rendered height, while the right column remains empty.
- Browser measurements confirmed Step 1, Step 3, and Step 6 render as PRIMARY FOCUS large left-column stacks and that the right-column stacks render the intended SECONDARY, TERTIARY, and QUATERNARY FOCUS labels.
- Browser measurements confirmed Step 6 uses /images/products_overlay_piccola_framed_no_island.png directly, while Step 6b and Step 6c use their no-frame transparent PNGs with 1440 / 2862 and 1440 / 2241 aspect ratios respectively.
- Sharp metadata confirmed alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png and products_overlay_piccola_framed_no_island.png are 1290 x 2661, products_overlay_piccola_isolated_large.png is 1440 x 2862, and products_overlay_piccola_overlay_only_large.png is 1440 x 2241.
- git diff --check passed for the committed source files app/globals.css and app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx. A broader diff-check reported trailing-whitespace warnings only inside generated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt line-numbered snapshot output, which is documentation inventory noise rather than app source whitespace.
- git branch -vv confirmed main and origin/main both pointed at 529c8b2 before this PDF was generated.

Files Touched

- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - added Step 0, Step 6b, and Step 6c to the Visual Hierarchy sequence; added visualHierarchyStepTitles for focus-header renaming; wired the Tutorial empty frame asset; wired Step 6 framed, Step 6b isolated, and Step 6c overlay-only shopping assets; added shopping-overlay variant logic; added Step 6 to the Viewing Area/brace behavior; hid screen labels for Tutorial and shopping variants; marked transparent assets unoptimized; and raised the Visual Hierarchy visible step limit to twelve.
- app/globals.css - added Visual Hierarchy section-break and tutorial-offset variables; inserted Step 0 grid placement; shifted existing Visual Hierarchy rows below the Tutorial subsection; positioned Step 6b and Step 6c beside Step 6; applied Step 6 to the large-stack brace sizing groups; tuned row-label positions for four subsections; and preserved the 24px label-to-image plus doubled subsection spacing rhythm.
- public/images/alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png - added the 1290 x 2661 blank Tutorial phone frame using the accepted no-island device shell and an empty dark screen.
- public/images/products_overlay_piccola_framed_no_island.png - added the 1290 x 2661 Step 6 framed shopping overlay with the Piccola screenshot underlay, device-frame overlay, and corner rounding matched to the existing Step 1/Step 2 framed assets.
- public/images/products_overlay_piccola_isolated_large.png - added the 1440 x 2862 Step 6b transparent no-frame shopping-overlay variant that keeps the requested overlay, SHOP/cart, close, arrows, center button, and internal orange footer visible.

- public/images/products_overlay_piccola_overlay_only_large.png - added the 1440 x 2241 Step 6c transparent no-frame overlay-only variant that keeps the product overlay and internal orange footer while hiding the surrounding control buttons.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed for the current Portfolio source tree, git state, public asset inventory, PDF inventory, validation context, and documentation pass.
- portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf - generated this new root-level PDF worklog artifact following the existing Portfolio naming, structure, metadata, length, and local documentation conventions.

Follow-Up Context

- The Visual Hierarchy section now has four conceptual subsections: TUTORIAL, PRE-SCROLLING, ON-SCROLLING, and DURING SHOPPING. Future additions should preserve the label-to-first-image spacing and doubled in-between-subsection spacing unless the entire rhythm is revisited.
- The Tutorial row intentionally has no right-column content. Future Tutorial imagery can use the same right-column pattern as the other rows, but the current blank space is deliberate rather than a missing render.
- Step 6 is now a generated framed derivative rather than the raw Piccola screenshot. If the raw shopping screenshot changes, the framed Step 6 image and the Step 6b/6c transparent variants should be regenerated together so overlay scale, cropping, and button visibility stay synchronized.
- Step 6b and Step 6c intentionally keep the orange banner inside the product overlay visible. Earlier instructions removed orange banners more broadly, but the final user correction restored the internal overlay footer for both files.
- Step 6 direct-loads its PNG to avoid stale optimized image output while iterating the frame/corner treatment. If the asset becomes stable for production-only optimization later, that choice can be revisited carefully.
- The UI Foundations view must remain active before browser scripts inspect Visual Hierarchy DOM. The Alla Vostra page still defaults to UX Product Flow, so automation should click UI Foundations first.
- The local Next.js workflow can show stale CSS or image output after rapid asset and layout changes. Future visual passes should keep using guarded .next cache removal, server restarts, Playwright measurements, and direct image-source checks when source and browser disagree.
- The Hostinger deployment path remains the GitHub Actions static-export workflow on pushes to main, publishing the out/ directory to the hostinger-deploy branch. No new production deployment command was part of this local-only visual pass.

Output Artifact

- Generated: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf
- Companion sync file: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt
- Source state reviewed: 529c8b2 on main and origin/main.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention: portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf. The Part 2 suffix was used because portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf already exists and this artifact covers the later August 12 Visual Hierarchy work.
- Next likely action: commit and push portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf with the refreshed snapshot when the user is ready to sync the documentation artifact.